



MyGurukul

SACRED WISDOM — SATURDAY, FEBRUARY 14, 2026



SACRED TEXT

etat trayam hi puruṣam nirdahed avamānitam | 4.136a
tasmād etat trayam nityam na-avamanyeta buddhimān || 136 || 4.136c
na-ātmānam avamanyeta purvābhir a.samṛddhibhiḥ | 4.137a
ā mrtyoḥ śriyam anvicchen na-enām manyeta dur.labhām || 137 || 4.137c

— Manusmṛti, 4.1.14. Rules of Conduct-III (Chapter 14), Verse 1

GURU'S INTERPRETATION

It cautions that three things, when disregarded, can consume a person, leading to inner turmoil and hindering spiritual progress. The wise individual, therefore, is urged to hold these three aspects in high esteem. The passage specifically emphasizes the importance of not devaluing oneself, particularly in the face of past failures or setbacks. It is a powerful reminder that your past does not define your potential.

Think of it as tending to a garden. If you constantly criticize the soil and neglect the seeds, nothing will flourish. Similarly, if you continuously dwell on past mistakes and tell yourself you are incapable of success, you are poisoning the wellspring of your potential. The scripture encourages you to actively seek prosperity and well-being throughout your life, never falling into the trap of believing it is unattainable. This isn't just about material wealth; it encompasses spiritual growth, fulfilling relationships, and a sense of purpose.

In modern life, this wisdom is especially relevant. We live in a world that often bombards us with unrealistic expectations and constant comparisons. Social media, in particular, can fuel feelings of inadequacy and self-doubt. It's easy to fall into the trap of believing that you are not good enough, successful enough, or worthy enough. This passage from the Manusmṛti serves as a powerful antidote to this negativity. It reminds you to cultivate self-compassion, acknowledge your inherent worth, and persistently pursue your aspirations. It encourages you to see setbacks not as definitive failures, but as opportunities for growth and learning. By valuing yourself and your potential, you unlock the door to a more fulfilling and meaningful life, regardless of external circumstances.

This isn't about arrogance or self-importance; it's about recognizing the divine spark within you and nurturing it with unwavering faith and self-respect. This passage is a call to action, urging you to actively cultivate a positive self-image and to persistently strive for your highest potential.

REFLECTION FOR TODAY

What small step can you take today to nurture your self-worth and remind yourself of your inherent potential?